

Refined Annotation Guidelines - Frames

1. Project Overview

This project aims to identify frames in argumentative texts from the **ChangeMyView (CMV)** dataset. Framing refers to determining which aspect/lens of a topic an argument emphasizes. By identifying the frame, we understand the perspective from which an author is building their argument.

2. Task

- **Task:** For each post or comment, select the most appropriate frame from the list of 15 dimensions.

3. The 15 Framing Dimensions

Use the following definitions based on the *Policy Frames Codebook*:

1. **Economic:** Costs, benefits, taxes, budgets, financial impact, or efficiency.
2. **Capacity and Resources:** Availability of physical resources, infrastructure, equipment, or manpower.
3. **Morality:** Ethical principles, duty, religious values, or "right vs. wrong" judgments.
4. **Fairness and Equality:** Human/civil rights, discrimination, social justice, or equal distribution of resources.
5. **Constitutionality and Law:** Legal procedures, court cases, the Constitution, or the legality of an action.
6. **Policy Evaluation:** The effectiveness, feasibility, or track record of specific government policies or laws.
7. **Crime and Punishment:** Law enforcement, criminal activity, sentencing, and the justice system.
8. **Security and Defense:** National security, protection against foreign threats, military action, or espionage.
9. **Health and Safety:** Physical health, disease, epidemics, and general safety risks to individuals.
10. **Quality of Life:** Personal well-being, happiness, environmental protection, or daily lifestyle.
11. **Cultural Identity:** National/group traditions, heritage, shared values, or cultural pride.
12. **Public Opinion:** Polls, what "the people" want, popularity, protests, or electoral support.
13. **Political:** Party politics, political strategy, winning/losing power, or election campaigns.

Economic: costs, benefits, or other financial implications
Capacity and resources: availability of physical, human or financial resources, and capacity of current systems
Morality: religious or ethical implications
Fairness and equality: balance or distribution of rights, responsibilities, and resources
Legality, constitutionality and jurisprudence: rights, freedoms, and authority of individuals, corporations, and government
Policy prescription and evaluation: discussion of specific policies aimed at addressing problems
Crime and punishment: effectiveness and implications of laws and their enforcement
Security and defense: threats to welfare of the individual, community, or nation
Health and safety: health care, sanitation, public safety
Quality of life: threats and opportunities for the individual's wealth, happiness, and well-being
Cultural identity: traditions, customs, or values of a social group in relation to a policy issue
Public opinion: attitudes and opinions of the general public, including polling and demographics
Political: considerations related to politics and politicians, including lobbying, elections, and attempts to sway voters
External regulation and reputation: international reputation or foreign policy of the U.S.
Other: any coherent group of frames not covered by the above categories

Figure 1: Framing dimensions from Boydston et al. (2014).

14. **Externalities:** Unintended side effects or indirect consequences (positive or negative) of a decision.
15. **Other:** Only use this for text that is clearly argumentative but does not fit any category above.

→ we used only the 15 frames of Card et al. (2015). We chose to go with these because they provide a comprehensive framework for not only analyzing policy issues but also the informal discussions of the CMV dataset.

4. Annotation Steps (Label Studio)

1. **Read the Original Post (OP):** Understand the main stance of the thread.
2. **Analyze the Sentence:** Identify keywords that signal a perspective (e.g., "tax" → Economic; "unconstitutional" → Law).
3. **Select Label:** Choose the best-fitting frame in **Label Studio**.
4. **Same OP?:** skip the post

4.1 Annotation examples

"CMV: Religion has no positive attributes" → morality

"CMV: Most 'big words' have no place outside of formal writing or speeches." → other

"CMV: Money to me is a renewable source so I just spend it knowing I'll get paid again so it'll come back" → economic

"CMV: There are no adequate gender equal options when it comes to changing your surname in marriage" → fairness and equality

"CMV: Watches today serve no functional purpose other than fashion, and therefore are a waste of money" → public opinion

4.2 Handling Multi-Frame Examples

One OP can have more than one frame. So multi-frame issues are possible. When deciding between two frames, choose both. This is good to reduce subjectivity. For example;

“CMV: I believe that blacks are genetically inferior to whites, Asians, and jews as far as intelligence is concerned.”

→ This could either be ‘morality’ or ‘cultural identity’, so both labels can be chosen.

5. During the annotation process

Doing more annotations, choosing the right frame became easier. This is because by doing the annotation you get a better understanding of the different frames.

after first 150 annotations:

Some frames were still unclear. For example, “Policy prescription and evaluation”. We made those frames clear to each other. Also the frames “Economic” and “Capacity and resources” are both possible in a lot of context, so a lot of times multiframing is possible.